This would return the 10 players in a sorted set named “player-scores,” ordered from highest to lowest.

The two most popular implementations of in-memory key-value stores are Memcached and Redis. Table 11.1 compares their features.

Table 11.1 Comparing Memcached and Redis features

	Memcached	Redis
Data types	Simple	Complex
Data manipulation commands	12	125
Server-side scripting	No	Yes (Lua)
Transactions	No	Yes

Examples are 100% covered by the Free Tier

The examples in this chapter are completely covered by the Free Tier. As long as you don’t run the examples longer than a few days, you won’t pay anything. Keep in mind that this applies only if you created a fresh AWS account for this book and nothing else is going on in your AWS account. Try to complete the chapter within a few days; you’ll clean up your account at the end of the sections.

Amazon ElastiCache offers Memcached and Redis clusters as a service. Therefore, AWS covers the following aspects for you:

- *Installation*—AWS installs the software for you and has enhanced the underlying engines.
- *Administration*—AWS administers Memcached/Redis for you and provides ways to configure your cluster through parameter groups. AWS also detects and automates failovers (Redis only).
- *Monitoring*—AWS publishes metrics to CloudWatch for you.
- *Patching*—AWS performs security upgrades in a customizable time window.
- *Backups*—AWS optionally backs up your data in a customizable time window (Redis only).
- *Replication*—AWS optionally sets up replication (Redis only).